

Elderly Needs

yb deraperP

daaS demahoM ynamA/rD

**Assistant Professor of Community Health Nursing
Department**

Outlines:-

1. Health needs of elderly: - I – Physiological needs.

II- Psychosocial needs.

III- Economic security needs.

2. Common health problems among elderly.

3. Role of the nurse in health promotion for older adults.

Health needs of elderly:-

A- Common health needs among elderly:-

The elderly, like any other age groups have certain basic needs: Physiological needs, and safety as well as the needs for love and belonging, self-esteem, and self-actualization. The elders' physical, emotional, and social needs are complex and interrelated. The following is an illustration of the common elderly needs:-

I – Physiological needs:-

a- Nutritional needs:-

Factors affecting nutritional status for elderly persons:

1-Age related changes:

- The body's rate of metabolism slows and no longer needs the same amount of energy
- Decrease in taste and smell there should will lessen interest in eating.
- Loss of natural teeth and poorly fitting dentures.
- Decrease absorption of certain nutrients.

2- Side effect of medication: Can reduce appetite and cause nausea.

3- Psychological factors: Loss of spouse, retirement, and living alone leads to changes in the socialization of eating.

4- Economical factors: Poor dietary intake associated with low income.

5- Cultural factors: Cultural eating habits may have a profound effect on nutritional status.

6- Medical problems: As in case of DM, HTN, and rthritis.....etc

7- Other factors as: - Cognitive impairment as in case of dementia .

b- Need for exercises:-

Exercise is consistently identified as one of the most significant health needs in the lives of the elderly. Positive effects of exercise include lowering of blood pressure, decreasing cholesterol level and decreasing bone loss. In addition, a regular exercise can enhance physical, social, and emotional well-being. Another important outcome of exercise is stress reduction which is linked to better sleep, muscle relaxation and improved self- concept.

c- Need for rest & sleep:-

Sleep is a restorative process, a time for cell growth and repair. The average persons will spend about one third of a life time a sleep.

The importance of rest and sleep:

- *Conserve energy.
- *Provide organ respite.
- *Restore the mental alertness and neurological efficiency.
- *Relieve tension.

Factors affecting sleeping patterns:

1- Age related sleep changes:

- Total sleep time decreases until age 80, and then increases slightly.
- Awakening is frequent, increasing after age 50 yrs.
- Frequency of abnormal breathing events is increased.
- Frequency of leg movements during sleep is increased.

2- Internal factors:

- Fear related to altered perception of night-time environment to sensory loss (vision/hearing).
- Fear of nightmares or fear of dying during sleep.
- Anxiety related to insomnia.
- Worry that may surround multiple losses (role, function, finances, friend(s), health, and independence).
- Other factors as: Pain, orthopnea, actual or feared urinary and /or fecal incontinence, constipation, and nausea .

3- External factors:

- Noise
- Excess or too little environmental lighting.
- Frequent awaking to provide continues care for the elderly (as in hospital setting).

D- Need for accident prevention:

Accidents are the fifth leading cause of death in the elderly. As falls, motor vehicle accidents, fires and contact with hot substances.

E- Need for periodic medical examination:

Importance:

- 1- Determine the client`s health status.
- 2- Assess the client`s level of well-being.
- 3- Detect early signs of disease.
- 4- Reinforce positive promoting and protecting behaviors.
- 5- Educating clients about actions that might promote his health status.

II- Psychosocial needs:-

Without healthy relationships with other people, life can be very lonely and lacking in quality. With advancing age, the psychosocial needs are many as:-

- 1- Coping with multiple losses; loss job, loss of finance, loss of space, reduction in health, and repetitive losses of relatives, or friends.
- 2- Maintaining independency.
- 3- Establishing usual social interaction.
- 4- Keeping a purpose in life.
- 5- Feeling of safety, love and belonging.

III- Economic security needs:-

Economic security is another major need for older adults. Fearing the potential costs of major illness and not wanting to be burden on family and friends, leading many older adults to conserve their limited finances by establishing unhealthy eating patterns, limited using for health resources, taking their medication in partial doses. Lacking in economic security prevents older adults from leading full and active lives.

B- Common health problems among elderly:-

- ***Disease and illness as :-***

1- Osteoarthritis.

2- Fractures.

3- Dental problems

4- Impairment of special senses

5- Cardio vascular disease and hypertension.

6- Hypothermia

7- Cancer & Prostate enlargement

8- Diabetes & Accidental falls

9- Urinary incontinence.

- *Psychological problems*

- 1- Emotional problems and depression.

- 2- Suicidal tendency

- 3- Senile dementia, Alzheimer disease.

- *Social problems*

1. Poverty& Loneliness.

2. Dependency & Isolation.

3. Elder abuse & Generation Gap.

Role of the nurse in health promotion for older adults:

Primary prevention

Healthy lifestyles which include the following :-

- 1- Adequate nutrition.
- 2- Exercise: - Make exercises regularly.
- 3- Rest and sleep: - Maintain & promote sleep for older adults.
- 4- Accident prevention:-Maintain Safety home and Prevent accident

5-Health screening and immunization: The nurse should educate the elderly about the importance of immunizations. and Screening should done for: Blood pressure, height and weight, dental health checkup, vision, hearing, cholesterol level, cancer screening, mammography and clinical breast cancer examination.

6- Smoking cessation should be followed.

7- Adjust and cope with the psychosocial changes of ageing :- by encourage older persons to discuss their family ,accept older persons discussions, and encourage participation in decision making .

Secondary prevention:

Secondary prevention focuses on early detection and prompt treatment of disease. For the common diseases in the elderly such as hypertension and cancer, screening has a vital role in the early diagnosis and treatment. Outcome of this secondary level of prevention may include cure or the prevention of complications or further disability.

Tertiary prevention

It includes rehabilitation: physical, medical and social. And prevention of disability that result from the effects of normal age-related changes, acute and/or chronic illness, and the demands of the social and physical environment.

THANK you